

ID: SOMA-M-P07

Title: Mindful Movements

Duration: 10m 00s (**705** words)

Script Content:

[Practice]

Today we will explore slow stretching and balancing movements. We intentionally slow down to pay close attention to the body. This is not a workout; please always experiment within your limits.

You may notice mind wandering, impatience, or discomfort. This is entirely normal. Simply guide your attention back to the body and observe the sensations. Always feel free to pause or adapt movements.

Let's begin by settling into a stable posture, feet hip-width apart. Have a chair nearby for support if needed. Allowing the arms to hang down along the sides of the body, fingers loose and relaxed.

Take a deep breath in. Slowly lift your shoulders toward your ears and notice the sensations. Then, breathe out and slowly relax your shoulders back down. And again, a deep breath in, lifting... noticing... and breathe out, releasing. One last time, deep breath in... and all the way out...

Taking a moment now to notice what might be here in the echo of that movement, such as tingling or stiffness or softness...

[Short Pause] (10s - Shoulder echo)

And now, moving your attention all the way down into the soles of your feet, noticing the contact with the ground. Perhaps a sense of pressure or warmth or coolness.

Keep your feet flat on the ground. Slowly shift your body to the left. Let your weight rest mostly on your left leg or hip. Taking good care of balance. Paying attention to any sensations in the left leg, and to the subtle difference in pressure underneath the left foot or buttock.

[Long Pause] (20s - Weight shift left)

Now kindly moving the body back to the center, as this too is a valuable opportunity to track sensations.

Now shift your body to the right. Maintain your balance. Notice if the sensations in your right leg and foot are similar or different.

[Long Pause] (30s - Weight shift right)

And then, maintaining your intentional curious awareness, shifting back to center.

Keep your feet flat. Shift your weight forward slightly. Let your weight rest on the balls of your feet and your toes. Staying here for a few moments, and then, with awareness, shifting back to center. Always taking good care.

[Short Pause] (10s - Forward shift)

And now, slowly shifting your body weight backwards just a little, and holding this posture for a few moments. Paying attention to the muscles in the body that are engaged in keeping this posture.

[Short Pause] (10s - Backward shift)

And slowly moving back to center.

And now, bringing our awareness to your right arm. On in-breath, slowly lifting your right arm up by the side, as if you are drawing a large semi-circle. Work within your limits. You can lift your arm towards the ceiling, or simply reach as high as feels comfortable.

Paying attention to the body in this extended posture. Noticing sensations. From muscle movements in different parts of your right arm, to even the air contacting the skin. Extend your fingers. Stretch further up or out to the side. Imagine you are almost touching the ceiling or the wall. Always taking good care of balance. And perhaps inviting an extra stretch by slowly spreading out the fingers.

[Long Pause] (30s - Right arm extension)

Slowly relax your fingers. Let your arm come back down. Breathe freely. Notice the sensations in your arm and hand right now.

[Short Pause] (10s - Right arm echo)

And then, slowly lifting the left arm up by the side, drawing a large semi-circle. Slowly lifting the left arm past the shoulder level, and reaching up towards the ceiling or simply as far up as you wish to go. Now stretching further up or out, including stretching the left hand and fingers. And then relaxing the hand, and allowing the arm to slowly come back down, noticing sensations.

[Short Pause] (10s - Left arm echo)

And now coming back to the stable standing or sitting posture, with your arms by the sides of the body. Noticing any and all sensations that may be present in the effect of these movements. Temperature, tightness, relaxation, heaviness, lightness, perhaps a change in energy levels...

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

And now, we will gently bring this practice to a close. It may be helpful to get a sense of the whole body standing or sitting. Perhaps taking a deeper breath or two if you like, and then opening your eyes if they were closed.

Thank you for your practice.

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